

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case No. 2017-4597

STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER

**IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE
PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF CELESTINA GARRISON,
LICENSE NO. LPC 5316,**

Respondent.

**IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Licensed
Professional Counselor Examiners ("Board") and Celestina Garrison ("Respondent") as
follows:**

- 1. The Board has jurisdiction over the person of Respondent and the
subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order ("Order").**
- 2. Respondent was licensed to practice as a Professional Counselor ("LPC")
in the State of Colorado at all times relevant herein.**
- 3. This Order is a full and final resolution of Case No. 2017-4597. This
Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to
the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.**
- 4. Respondent admits the following:**
 - a. On or about June 15, 2010, Respondent pled guilty to DUI, a
misdemeanor, in Case No. 2009T17494 in County Court, El Paso County,
Colorado. She received a deferred sentence that included 30 days in
jail, which was suspended, twelve (12) months of unsupervised
probation, and community service. On July 18, 2011, Respondent
completed the terms of the deferred sentence, and the case was
dismissed.**

b. On or about September 30, 2015, Respondent pled guilty to DUI, a misdemeanor, in Case No. 2015T1211 in County Court, El Paso County, Colorado. She was sentenced to 120 days in jail, which was suspended, 30 days of in-home detention, and twelve (12) months of supervised probation.

c. On or around October 13, 2017, Respondent submitted to an evaluation, and the evaluator concluded that Respondent is not safe to practice with reasonable skill and safety without treatment and monitoring.

d. Respondent failed to report the DUI convictions to the Board.

5. By virtue of the facts admitted in paragraph 4 above, the Board finds that Respondent violated §12-43-222(1)(e) and (s), C.R.S.

§12-43-222. Prohibited activities--related provisions. (1) A person licensed, registered, or certified under this article violates this article if the person:

(e) Habitually or excessively uses or abuses alcohol, a habit-forming drug, or a controlled substance, as defined in section 18-18-102(5), C.R.S.;

(s) Has resorted to fraud, misrepresentation, or deception in applying for or in securing licensure or taking any examination provided for in this article.

PROBATION

6. Respondent's license to practice professional counseling shall be placed on probation for a minimum period of three (3) years. Credit toward satisfying the period of probation shall be given only during such periods of time that Respondent is in total compliance with all provisions of this Order. The prescribed period of probation shall not run during any period of time when:

a. Respondent is not practicing as a LPC or engaged in the practice of professional counseling in the State of Colorado;

b. Respondent is not actively participating in a Board-approved peer assistance services program as set forth below in paragraphs 7 and 8 of this Order; and

- c. Respondent is not otherwise in full compliance with the terms of this Order.

PEER ASSISTANCE SERVICES ("PAS")

7. As a term of this Order and Respondent's probationary status, Respondent shall enter into and successfully complete a contract with PAS for a minimum period of three (3) years, or until successful completion of the probationary terms and conditions ordered herein, whichever occurs later.

8. Respondent shall enter into a contract with PAS within fourteen (14) days from the effective date of this Order. Respondent agrees to cease the practice of professional counseling after fourteen (14) days until such time as Respondent enters into a contract with PAS.

- a. **Therapy Monitoring.** As a requirement of her contract with PAS, Respondent shall undergo individual therapy with an approved mental health provider, at a frequency and duration to be determined by PAS, as specified in the PAS contract signed by Respondent.
- b. **Urine/Blood Screens.** As a requirement of her PAS contract, Respondent shall submit to full panel urine or blood tests during participation in PAS, as ordered by the Board, Respondent's employer, or Respondent's treatment program monitor, at a frequency determined by Respondent's treatment program contract. All screens or tests shall be administered and monitored by approved program personnel. An overly dilute or missed urine screen or blood test shall be presumed positive for prohibited substances. Use or ingestion of poppy seeds or hemp oil shall not excuse a positive urine screen or blood test. Respondent must submit satisfactory verified test results for all random urine screening or blood testing conducted as part of Respondent's treatment program with Respondent's application for discharge of the probation period.
- c. **Other Requirements.** Respondent shall comply fully and in a timely manner with all requirements, recommendations, restrictions, and directions of the treatment program, as specified in the PAS contract signed by Respondent.
- d. **Releases.** Respondent hereby waives any right or claim of confidentiality to any information, test results, or other data pertaining to Respondent's treatment progress, or lack thereof, with PAS, and will

execute a release authorizing PAS to release any and all information pertaining to Respondent's case to the Board upon its request. Respondent shall keep all releases current and in effect.

e. Completion of Program. If Respondent satisfactorily completes the treatment program, verification to the Board by PAS of the completion of treatment shall be deemed sufficient, and the requirements set out herein shall be deemed satisfied, unless other information is reasonably required by the Board to verify Respondent's completion of treatment. It is Respondent's responsibility to ensure that PAS submits verification to the Board of completion of treatment.

f. Withdrawal from Program. Respondent must immediately notify the Board in writing if Respondent withdraws from, is removed from, is terminated from, or otherwise fails to participate fully and satisfactorily in Respondent's treatment program.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

9. Respondent will strictly observe the prohibitions set forth in §12-43-222, C.R.S., and will ensure that she does not engage in any activities that are prohibited and that she practices in accordance with the generally accepted standards of practice.

10. Respondent shall not supervise or consult with other mental health providers for the purpose of those persons providing mental health services, unless such supervision or consultation is monitored in accordance with this Order.

11. All expenses incurred or associated with any other requirement necessary to fulfill the terms of this Order, shall be the sole responsibility of Respondent and not the Board.

12. In the event Respondent relocates at any time during the probationary period, Respondent shall notify the Board of the change of address within 30 days of the effective date of such change.

13. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to §12-43-224, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

14. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

15. This Order shall become an order of the Board when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representative.

24. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of §12-43-222, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to §12-43-224, C.R.S.

16. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

17. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Board. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

18. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Board, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Board. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Board.

19. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Board.

20. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT



CELESTINA GARRSION
LPC 5316

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL
COUNSELOR EXAMINERS



DARCIE MAGNUSON
Program Director

Effective this 11th day of
January, 2018.